

Phishing Attack

Another clever ploy used by hackers to steal data is to redirect the victim to a malicious website which feels authentic. The user enters sensitive information in the dummy website, which is redirected to the hacker.

Domain Name System Hijacking

The hacker changes the DNS setting to point to the hacker's web server. All traffic is redirected to a new server which can later be used to extract critical information.

How to Hack a Web Server

Information can be collected about a web server from multiple sources:

- Websites
- WHOIS information (Directory Traversal)
- Netcraft information (DOS Attack)
- Banner grabbing
- Port scanning with Nmap
- Mirroring a website using Htttrack (Phishing Attack)

Most organizations have websites which store valuable information like credit card numbers, email addresses and passwords. This has made them a target for hackers. Defaced websites can also be used to spread propaganda like radical religious or political ideologies.

This article aims to introduce you to web servers hacking techniques and ways to counter them.

Web server vulnerabilities

A web server has both hardware and software components. Hackers target the software component to gain unauthorized entry to the web server. Here are some of the common vulnerabilities that hackers exploit.

Default settings

Default settings leave the server open to most tricks employed by the hackers. These settings, which might include the default username and password, can be easily guessed by the hackers. Default settings might also allow dangerous scripts stitched by hackers to run on the server without authorization.